



GDD 62

Equal Parents

Not 'helping'. Parenting. Both of you.

Equal Partners (g55), grown up into raising children, the stage where gendered defaults snap back hardest. It supports genuinely shared parenting, the night feeds and the appointments, the planning and the worrying (the parental mental load), and involved, hands-on fatherhood, and makes the point that children learn equality first by watching it at home. Even-handed and pro-men; everyone gains. Seven mechanics, 26 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Parenting isn't mum's job.

Equal Parents takes the equal-home work of Equal Partners (g55) into raising children, the stage where gendered defaults snap back hardest. It supports genuinely shared parenting: the night feeds and the doctor's appointments, the planning and the worrying (the parental mental load), and involved, hands-on fatherhood. And it makes the point that children learn equality first by watching it at home. It engages fathers as equal owners rather than helpers, frames involved fatherhood as pro-men, never shames any current arrangement, and routes parental burnout to support. New v2 build, the gender-equality thread carried into parenthood.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g62 · equal-parents (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / stage	Chapter 8 · Parenthood, first child on · adult / honest / even-handed
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.2, 1.4, 1.1
Prerequisite / builds on	g61 · builds on g55 (Equal Partners), g26 (Equalize) · beside g61, links g63
Gating	Open · even-handed; engages fathers; never anti-men
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the equal-parents game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

17

myth-flips

26

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

A father isn't a babysitter; co-parenting is shared ownership. Both parents can do the feeds, the nights and the appointments, and only breastfeeding is mother-specific; sharing the parental mental load means owning the noticing and planning, not doing tasks on request. Involved, hands-on fatherhood is good fathering and a fuller manhood, and it's pro-men, lifting fathers' bonds and wellbeing. Children learn equality by watching their parents, so modelling shared care breaks the cycle, and shared parenting is better for kids, mothers and fathers alike: everyone gains.

From 'helping' to owning, together.

From the Chapter 8 personas (parenthood). Fathers who want to be good dads and be seen as one, mothers carrying the default load, and couples raising children who want their kids to grow up seeing equality, the persona note: end "babysitting", move from helping to owning, fix the default-parent pattern.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Vikram (the father)	To own an equal share and be a hands-on dad.	strike-rewrite + role-play : involved dads.
Divya (default-loaded)	The mental load seen and genuinely shared.	sort + branch : parental mental load.
Priya & Meena	To raise kids who learn equality at home.	strike-rewrite + reflect : kids are watching.
Both parents	A fair-split plan that everyone gains from.	match + branch : everyone gains, tools.

Why this works (the evidence). Genuinely shared parenting splits the visible care and the invisible mental load, with each parent owning whole domains rather than doing tasks on request; only breastfeeding is mother-specific, and the load is built by practice, not biology. Involved fatherhood is good fathering: infants attach to both parents from birth, and paternal involvement lifts children's cognitive, emotional and behavioural development, while quality of engagement matters most. Fathers face real barriers, the provider role, maternal gatekeeping, unequal leave, but equality is pro-men. Children learn gender roles by watching their parents, shared parenting is a whole-family gain, and parenthood is when equality matters most.

Seven moves, led by the flip and the choice.

It's an equality game, so **strike-rewrite** leads (busting 'dad just helps' and 'mum's the natural parent') with **branch** for the owning-it choices and **sort** for the balancing-sim (whose task, fair vs lopsided); **role-play** gives fathers the words. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a gendered-parenting myth.	Conceptual change.	17
branch (the choice)	Chooses to own a share, not just help.	Judgement.	16
reflect	Internalises kids-are-watching and everyone-gains.	Values.	12
sort	Sorts visible vs mental load; fair vs lopsided; either vs mum.	The line.	11
match	Pairs a duty to a fair split; a home pattern to what kids learn.	Connections.	10
role-play (voice)	Claims competence, owns a domain, reframes for a friend.	Voice; care.	10
spot	Spots equal-parent vs helper; what teaches kids equality.	Reading it.	8

26 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is recognition and a fairer, lighter home: the relief of seeing the invisible load named, the pride of a father claiming real competence, and the quiet power of knowing your kids are learning equality by watching you. The "oh, this is mine to own, not help with" moment lands repeatedly. Sam is a warm adult peer; the tone is even-handed and pro-men, engaging fathers as equal owners, never anti-men, and never shaming any current arrangement.

Is it teaching?

Yes: sharing childcare and the parental mental load fairly through owned domains; recognising and resisting the 'mum's job' default; supporting involved, hands-on fatherhood; and understanding that modelling equality at home is the most powerful lesson a child gets, with parental burnout routed to support.

The belief it moves. From "care is mum's job; dad just helps or babysits; providing is enough; doing tasks when asked is equal; mums are naturally better at the load; kids don't notice; equality is a sacrifice; equality takes a back seat after kids" → "both are real parents; a father owns his share; presence matters; sharing means owning the noticing; the load is practised not innate; kids learn by watching; everyone gains; and parenthood is when equality matters most."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the share-the-care → mental-load → involved-dads → kids-are-watching → everyone-gains → tools arc, India-grounded, even-handed and warm. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Share the care	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Feeds, nights, appointments in fair owned shares.
The parental mental load	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Share the remembering; own the noticing, not tasks.
Involved dads	14	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Hands-on, present fatherhood; pro-men; gatekeeping.
Kids are watching	14	strike-rewrite, reflect, sort	Model equality; break the cycle; chores no gender.
Everyone gains	14	strike-rewrite, match, reflect	Better for kids, mothers & fathers; not a sacrifice.
Tools & help	14	branch, role-play, sort	The fair-parenting & mental-load map; rebalance; burnout.

The 'babysitting' flip + the 'tasks when asked' flip, verbatim.

flip: "A father looking after his own child is 'babysitting' / 'helping mum'."
 UN -> "A father caring for his own child is babysitting or helping mum."
 RE -> "It's just parenting; caregiving is a father's own responsibility, not help he gives the mother."

flip: "If I do tasks when asked, I'm sharing the parenting equally."
 UN -> "Doing tasks when asked is sharing equally."
 RE -> "Being asked still leaves one parent the manager who notices and remembers; sharing means owning the noticing too."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 62 Equal Parents — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Hands-on childcare is naturally the mother's job.	Both parents can do it all; only breastfeeding is mother-specific.	Care isn't gendered.
A father caring for his child is 'babysitting'.	It's parenting, his own responsibility, not a favour.	Not babysitting.
Fathers are providers; nurturing isn't a man's role.	Men nurture fully; involved fathers help kids and themselves.	Men nurture.
If I do tasks when asked, I'm sharing equally.	Sharing means owning the noticing and planning, not tasks-on-request.	Share the thinking.
Mums are just naturally better at remembering the kid stuff.	It's practice, not biology; both can carry the mental load.	Not natural.
Kids don't notice who does what at home.	Children learn gender roles by watching; home is their model.	Kids notice.
Equal parenting is a sacrifice fathers make for mothers.	It's better for children, mothers and fathers, everyone gains.	Win for all.
Once kids arrive, gender equality takes a back seat.	Parenthood is when equality matters most; hold the line.	Matters most.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (adult peer) surfaces a real moment, a defaulted night feed, an invisible load, a 'babysitting' jibe, a watching child.
2. **Choose or voice.** The adult chooses to own a share, not just help (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a gendered-parenting myth; RE writes the even-handed truth.
4. **Share & model.** Split care and the mental load into owned domains; model the equality kids absorb.
5. **Gains & help.** See the whole-family gain; parental burnout routes to Looking After You (g63).
6. **Sticker.** The Equal Parents badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **helping-to-owning** shift and the **kids-are-watching** realisation. It carries Equal Partners (g55) and Equalize (g26) into parenting, sits beside Us, After Kids (g61), links Looking After You (g63), and models for the next generation the equality the whole curriculum teaches.

Even-handed; pro-men; never shaming.

- **Engages fathers as equal owners.** The node speaks to fathers directly and frames involved fatherhood as pro-men, a gain to claim, never anti-men.
- **No shaming of any current arrangement.** It offers a fairer path and tools, not blame for how a family parents now.
- **Mindful of joint-family realities.** It respects the help (and pressure) of grandparents while keeping both parents central and hands-on.
- **Names the structural reality.** In India care defaults to mothers and grandmothers and paternity leave is minimal; the node works within that while shifting caregiving from 'help' to responsibility.
- **Parental burnout flagged.** Persistent depletion routes to Looking After You (g63) and support; rebalancing the load is part of the fix.
- **Children's wellbeing centred.** The case for equality rests on what's best for the child as much as fairness for the parents.
- **Access & privacy.** Self-directed, audio, offline, low-end build; private by design (DPDP-aligned); expert-reviewed.

Pro-men, pro-kids, pro-family (India). Involved fatherhood lifts children's development and a father's own bond, confidence and wellbeing, it's a gain, not a loss. Care defaults to mothers and grandmothers and paternity leave is minimal, so this is about turning caregiving from 'help' into shared responsibility. If a parent is burning out, rebalance the load and see Looking After You (g63); for mental-health support, Tele-MANAS **14416**.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. equal-parents** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** myth flip and the **branch** own-it choice co-lead.
- **Even-handedness is a hard requirement.** Engages-fathers, pro-men, never-anti-men and no-shaming are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** Paternal-involvement benefits, quality-over-frequency, maternal gatekeeping, intergenerational modelling, and India father-caregiving/leave context verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 20%, 0% binary, 26 autonomy, 17 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Parental burnout routes to g63 and perinatal/mental-health support (Tele-MANAS 14416).
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g62 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): engages fathers as equal owners; pro-men, never anti-men; no shaming of any arrangement; children's wellbeing centred; parental burnout routed to help; mindful of joint-family realities; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Care is learned, so it's shareable.** Because only breastfeeding is mother-specific and the mental load is built by practice, teaching both parents to own domains genuinely redistributes the work.
- **Involved fatherhood helps everyone, so champion it.** Since paternal involvement lifts child development and fathers' own wellbeing, framing it as pro-men and addressing gatekeeping turns 'help' into shared responsibility.
- **Kids learn by watching, so model it.** Because children absorb gender roles from their parents, modelling shared care is the most powerful lesson and a way to break an intergenerational cycle.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concept 3 (gender) and 1 (families); UN Women / UNICEF on equal and involved parenting and men's caregiving (MenCare); research on paternal involvement and children's cognitive, emotional, social and behavioural development (with quality of engagement mattering most, and barriers including the provider role and maternal gatekeeping); the parental mental load and division-of-labour research; and India studies on father caregiving, time use and the intergenerational transmission of gender roles, alongside the structural reality of minimal paternity leave. Even-handed and pro-men, engaging fathers as equal owners and never anti-men, never shaming any current arrangement, with parental burnout routed to Looking After You (g63). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 62 games now v2. Next by order: Looking After You (g63).